



Decorated commander

As commanding general, Vo Nguyen Giap led communist forces to victory in the First Indochina War and the Vietnam War. He received many medals and honors, including Vietnam's highest decoration: the Gold Star Order.

Young subversive

Following in his father's footsteps, Giap was active in politics from an early age. He joined underground revolutionary groups and spent the late 1920s and early 1930s agitating against French rule in Indochina. When the Communist Party was outlawed by the French at the start of World War II, Giap took refuge across the border in China, where he linked